```
document.querySelector '#status'
# document.querySelector is not a function
```

Your browser-based program has to run on many different browsers. Each browser may or may not support a particular browser feature that you use in your program (even when those features are standardized). Special objects that belong to the browser called *host objects* provide some of those features. You've already encountered the `XMLHttpRequest` and `document` host objects.

Feature detection

The technique demonstrated in this section is called *feature detection* because it checks to see whether a runtime has a specific feature and defines it if it does not. A contrasting approach is to detect the runtime instead of the feature. Detecting the runtime proves to be ultimately unmaintainable and isn't recommended except in rare cases where a runtime is completely broken.

Web browsers define host objects such as the `document` object. They might not be defined outside of a browser, such as on the REPL:

```
document?
# false
```

Host objects are part of the Document Object Model (DOM) and can differ wildly across browsers. Although the behavior of *some* host objects is standardized, you should anticipate that different browsers will behave differently. More importantly, host objects don't behave like regular objects. They might *look* like regular objects, but they're not. *Don't expect host objects to work like regular objects.*

The Document Object Model

The convention, or model, that defines how your browser-based application interacts with host objects that belong to the document loaded by the web